

Insecure At Work?

Simple security measures—including properly setting up shared folders and choosing good passwords—can reduce common workplace problems such as intrusions and stolen data

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As competition grows, businesses need to become smarter and warier. Often, we hear of employees being poached by the competition, of security lapses and data theft. Since computers took over managing our daily business chores, paranoia has reigned the masses; well at least the smarter ones...

Does this all sound alien? Are you wondering what on Earth we're on to? We certainly hope not, because it would mean that you haven't even been worried about confidential data that's stored on your company computers. Whether its employee PCs or the company's file or Web server, there's always some data the security of which keeps the bosses awake at night!

Most regular employees will probably be frowning really hard right now trying to comprehend, while most senior management people are nodding their heads off in approval! Sadly, that's the case in most companies across our country, with only a few corporates and even fewer medium-sized companies having a data security or protection system and process in place.

It's almost always the middle to senior management that's entrusted the task of securing their own data, and no training is given to the legions below. Why? It's either because we're too lazy, too paranoid, or just too ignorant of the risks.

Consider this: according to various studies conducted by research agencies such as the US Department of Commerce, as much as nine per cent of all data lost is stolen! So whether it's a teenage hacker, who could also be on a competitor's payroll, or your own employees and colleagues, chances are your data will be/has been/is being stolen, right from under your nose.

Who Wants My Files?

You'll be surprised at the importance of almost every company-related document you have, especially if you are at the middle management level!

Let's take, for example, your team's payroll file. Here's a file that only contains a list of names and their salaries. How could anyone but the accounts guys have any interest in that? Right? Wrong! Your team members may or may not discuss each other's salaries, especially if there is disparity in